

COLUMBA

The Dove

Dutch map-maker Petrus Plancius created Columba in 1592. It depicts the dove that Noah released from the Ark to find dry land. Its brightest star is Phact, from the Arabic "ring dove".

DATA FILE



SIZE RANKING: 54th



BRIGHTEST STAR: Phact



MONTH WHEN BEST VISIBLE:
February – Southern hemisphere



PYXIS

The Compass

French astronomer Nicolas Louis de Lacaille devised this faint southern constellation in the 1750s during his survey of the southern sky. Pyxis depicts a magnetic compass, as used on ships.

DATA FILE



SIZE RANKING: 65th



BRIGHTEST STAR: Alpha Pyxidis



MONTH WHEN BEST VISIBLE:
March – Southern hemisphere

